



UNITED STATES MARINE CORPS
MARINE CORPS RESERVE POLICY BOARD
OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF THE NAVY
(MILITARY MANPOWER AND PERSONNEL - RESERVE MATTERS)
RM 4D548, 1000 NAVY PENTAGON
WASHINGTON, D.C., 20350-1000

11 Oct 2023

From: Chairman, Marine Corps Reserve Policy Board
To: Assistant Secretary of the Navy (M&RA)

Subj: CY 2023 ANNUAL REPORT OF THE MARINE CORPS RESERVE POLICY BOARD (MCRPB)

Ref: (a) Title 10, United States Code, Section 10304
(b) SECNAVINST 5420.170N
(c) CY 2022 Annual Report of the Marine Corps Reserve Policy Board
(d) MCO 5420R.8H

Encl: (1) MCRPB Membership Roster for 2023
(2) MCRPB Joint Issue Recommendations
(3) MCRPB Marine Corps Issue Recommendations
(4) MCRPB Nominated Membership for 2024-2026

1. The Marine Corps Reserve Policy Board (MCRPB or The Board) was established by section 10304 of reference (a) to "consider, recommend, and report to the Secretary of the Navy on Reserve policy matters."

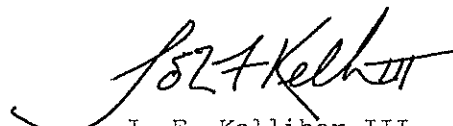
2. The Board's annual report for 2023 is submitted pursuant to reference (b) to summarize deliberations and actions of the Board since its last annual report of reference (c). Enclosure (1) reflects the current composition of the Board.

3. The Board met on 7 September 2023 to review and finalize policy recommendations and actions for 2023. The Board considered two broad categories of issues. The first category are issues of a 'Joint' nature and beyond the scope of the Marine. Enclosure (2) reflects the Board's policy recommendations on Joint issues. The second category are those issues which are within the scope of the Marine Corps to change. Enclosure (3) reflects the Board's policy recommendations on Marine Corps Issues.

4. The Board met in joint session with the National Navy Reserve Policy Board (NNRPB) on 8 September 2023 per references (a) and (b) to collaborate on policy issues which are in the interest of both services.

5. The Board concluded its Fall 2023 session on 9 September 2023 by deliberating and voting on new member applications for 2024 to 2026. The nominated members are listed in enclosure (4).

6. Reference (d) is the Marine Corps Order (MCO) governing the composition and conduct of the MCRPB. With the recent revision to reference (b) The Board will be reviewing and proposing updates the the MCO in 2024.


J. F. Kelliher III
MajGen, USMCR
Chairman

ENCLOSURE 1 - MCRPB Membership Roster for 2023

Membership of the Board:

<u>Rank/Name</u>	<u>Component</u>	<u>Term Expiration</u>
MajGen John Kelliher III	USMCR	Dec 2024
BGen Valerie A. Jackson	USMCR	Dec 2025
BGen Raymond Adams	USMCR	Dec 2025
Col Jenny Storm	USMCR	Dec 2023, Board Chief of Staff
Col Elizabeth Perazzo	USMCR(AR)	Billet, HQMC (RAP)
Col Edward Shea	USMCR	Dec 2023
Col Maisie Wong	USMCR	Dec 2024
CAPT Corry Kucik	USN	Billet, MARFORRES Force Surgeon
LtCol James Graham	USMC(AR)	Billet, HQMC (PP&O)
LtCol Gary Sampson	USMC	Dec 2024
LtCol Jason Smedley	USMCR	Dec 2025
Maj David Mabon	USMCR	Dec 2023, Board Secretary
Capt Marshal Andrews	USMCR	Dec 2025
SgtMaj Ruben Esparza	USMCR	Billet, HQMC (RA)
SgtMaj Jon Grinter	USMCR	Dec 2023
SgtMaj Edwin Mota	USMC	Billet, MARFORRES SgtMaj
SgtMaj John Tacopino	USMCR	Dec 2024
MSgt Christopher Magner	USMCR	Dec 2025
Maj David Carpenter	USMCR(AR)	Dec 2023 (Alternate)
Maj Ismael Lopez	USMCR	Dec 2023 (Alternate)
MGySgt Jason Hart	USMCR	Dec 2023 (Alternate)

The following staff supported the Board and provided logistical support for the proceedings. They also participated in board deliberations when requested.

<u>Rank/Name</u>	<u>Component</u>	<u>Department</u>
LtCol John Pomy	USMCR(AR)	DASN (MMP)
Maj Jason Shao	USMCR(AR)	HQMC (RAP-1)
Maj Krysta Porterlott	USMC	HQMC (RAP-1)
Maj Ben Barnes	USMCR	DASN (MMP)

ENCLOSURE 2 - MCRPB Joint Issue Recommendations

Issue 2018-a: Reservist Contribution Limits to Blended Retirement System

Recommendation:

The Board reiterates its joint recommendation with the NNRPB for an update to legislation so Reserve Component servicemember elective deferrals to military retirement savings be separated, but similarly limited from the contributions made to their civilian retirement programs. Specifically, the Board recommends the Department of the Navy initiate a legislative proposal request as expeditiously as possible. With your concurrence, the Board will also raise this matter with the Reserve Forces Policy Board.

Background:

This has been a joint recommendation with the NNRPB since 2018. The Board recommended a Reservist be able to access the matching contributions of the new Blended Retirement System by creating a law that would permit a separate but similar legal contribution limit for self-contributions to retirement programs. Many Reservists already have 401(k) or 401(k)-like defined contribution retirement programs through their civilian employment. Said another way, Reservists who are maximizing their own contributions to their civilian retirement programs up to the legal authorized limit are precluded from making contributions from their military pay to the Thrift Savings Plan. This also prevents their ability to access the government's matching contribution and reduces the value of their reserve retirement benefits and is not in parity with the active component.

Issue 2018-b: Reduced Age Retirement Benefits for Reserve Component Marines

Recommendation:

The Board voted to monitor the issue as there is currently new legislation being proposed. H.R. 3668 May 26, 2023

Background:

Current law, under 10 USC § 12731 allows for non-regular retirement pay if a member performs at least 20 years of qualifying service and attains the eligible age. Generally, the age of eligibility is 60; however, this number can be reduced, by a maximum of ten years (down to age 50), if a reservist serves on qualifying "active duty" orders. This reduction in age eligibility is not granted to reserve service members for the purpose of medical and dental care entitlements.

H.R. 1997 introduced on 18 Mar 2021, TRICARE Fairness for National Guard and Reserve Retiree Act aligns eligibility for TRICARE coverage with reduced age retirement eligibility. Representative Dean Phillips; LtGen Dana T. Akins, USAF (Ret), Military Officers Association of America president and CEO; and the Reserve Organization of America support this bill. This bill was not passed. H.R. 3668 has now been proposed on May 26. 2023.

Issue 2019-03: Reserve Component Statements of Service

Recommendation:

Monitor the issue pending the implementation of the policy within the Marine Corps.

Background:

The issue of creating a comprehensive documentation process for Reserve members of the U.S. Department of Defense has been a topic of ongoing discussion and action. The matter initially gained attention when the Secretariat responded to the Marine Corps Reserve Policy Board (MCRPB) and the National Naval Reserve Policy Board (NNRPB), indicating that a Statement of Service Working Group (SSWG) was established in January 2020. The SSWG was tasked with developing a Department of Defense (DoD) form to fully capture the scope of service for Reserve members beyond just their active-duty stints.

On February 17, 2022, the DoD Instruction 1336.01 Certificate of Uniformed Service was published. This new policy mandates the creation of a DD 214-1, a "reserve addendum," designed to capture information specific to Reserve Component (RC) service. The directive stipulates that implementation of this new form is required by February 2025.

This issue was brought to the MCRPB for a closure vote on July 1, 2022, and was officially closed by a unanimous vote on July 14, 2022. Despite the closure vote by MCRPB, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of the Navy (DASN) noted on August 14, 2023, that the issue remains open pending the implementation of the new policy and the associated DD 214-1 form.

Issue 2020-03: Legal Services for Reservists Continued after Deactivation

Recommendation:

The Board voted to action this issue and collaborate with the NNRPB. In the joint session there was a vested interest regarding not only the MCRPB specific matter, but other legal support for reservists outside of their duty status.

Background:

The requirement for legal assistance should be based on date of occurrence(s) and associated duty status not on a service members current duty status. The current policy requires the reservist to obtain legal services at his/her own expense even if the reason for requesting legal services occurred or is expected to occur during a status which met eligibility requirements.

The MCRPB is most interested in this policy to seek assistance when a RC member demobilizes and still requires legal assistance. The NNRPB is most interested in obtaining pre-mobilization legal assistance for wills and powers of attorney, but both Boards acknowledge that this policy requires change in order to obtain the support requested.

The policy regarding the legal assistance/service for reserve and guard members begins in U.S.C 10 § 1044 and echoes down through the JAGMAN § 0705 and subsequently the JAGINST 5801.2B Appendix A and MCO 5800.16 V-5 § 0105. The policy change would have to be addressed via the SECNAV at the JAGMAN level.

Impacts of recommended policy changes drew concerns from the head of the Legal Assistance Dept at the Judge Advocate Division over staffing availability issues and the increased workload on JAG Legal Services/Assistance across all branches.

The policy, if changed, would affect thousands of personnel to include the reserve/guard members and their dependents who are making the claims for assistance as well the legal service providers, both military and civilian.

The timeline to implement this policy for change would be lengthy as it would require a higher echelon of policy change which would then affect all branches of service who then need to adjust their follow-on orders.

Speaking with Legal Assistance Officers, there seems to be a common opinion that if the service member needs support and they can help, they would do it. Current workload and other circumstances would play into that decision, but overall, they would like to support the service member regardless of the service member's current status.

Once Marine reservists de-mobilize, the majority of them depart the area where Marine Corps/Naval Legal Assistance is routinely provided (i.e., Camp Lejeune, Camp Pendleton). As they return to their home of record, they may have to rely on other branches of services located at military installations closer to them for the legal assistance.

Issue 2020-07: AFRM "M" device requirements

Ref: (a) SECNAV M-1650.1
(b) DoDM 1348.33, Vol. 2

Recommendation:

Monitor this issue pending updated SECNAV instruction guidance.

Background:

The requirements for the Armed Forces Reserve Medal (AFRM) "M" device are unclear. Reference (a) states that the "M" device is earned per par d.(2) and d.(3). However, the "M" device is discussed in paragraph d.(1). Paragraph d.(1) includes references to paragraphs within sections that appear to be a typo.

The Navy Department Board Decorations and Medals has received the Marine Corps' recommendations for the AFRM "M" device. Recommendations will be integrated into the draft re-issuance of SECNAV M-1650.1. This is currently being reviewed by the Awards Branch of M&RA.

Issue 2020-15: Transfer of Education Benefits

Ref: (a) Title 38 U.S. Code, § 3319 - Authority to transfer unused education benefits to family member

(b) DODI 1341.13 - Post 9/11 GI Bill

Recommendation:

The Board voted to advocate for a change in language for the issue related to the challenges to Transfer of Education Benefits (TEB) and recommends the Secretary of the Navy support the prioritization and completion of this reform.

Background:

The Post 9/11 Transfer of Education Benefits, codified in ref (a), allows service members with at least six years' time-in-serve to transfer their post 9/11 Education Benefits to their immediate dependents. The service member is required to serve an additional continuous four years on active duty or as an actively drilling reservist.

Ref (b), places an additional administrative restriction on service members in which they cannot remain in an Individual Ready Reserve (IRR) status for more than 24 hours or they will forfeit time accrued towards the four-year service period. This creates an unnecessary burden for service members as they may incidentally be dropped to IRR status between different active statuses temporarily, but for more than 24 hours (i.e., Active Duty for Operational Support (ADOS) to Selected Marine Corps Reserve (SMCR), or Active Reserve to SMCR, or interunit transfer between SMCR units).

The Board supports efforts to expand the 24-hour grace period to 30 days to allow room for error for administrative issues in status changes for the service member. The Board proposes the Office of the Under Secretary of Defense (USD) administer a change to verbiage in Section 3.3.b.(4), pg. 11, "The member transferring educational benefits must agree to serve 4 additional years in the Military Services, NOAA Corps, or USPHS Corps from the date of election, with no break in active or Selected Reserve service for greater than 24 hours".

This issue was discussed and deliberated with the NNRPB which agreed to support monitoring and implementation at the USD level.

Therefore, the Board recommends continued advocacy by Department of the Navy & the Marine Corps leadership to continue to work with Department of Defense and Under Secretary of Defense leadership to ensure TEB grace period is prioritized and expanded.

Issue 2022-02: Update IDT Travel Reimbursement limits

Ref: (a) CY2022 MCRPB Annual Report

Recommendation:

The Board voted to continue monitoring this issue and recommends continued advocacy to the Per Diem, Travel, and Transportation Allowance Committee (PDTATAC) to implement updates to the JTR concerning Inactive Duty Training (IDT) travel reimbursements when traveling "outside the Normal Commuting Distance". Increases should be made to the maximum allowable reimbursement limit and the authorized mileage reimbursement rate.

Background:

As discussed in reference (a), IDT Reimbursement has not kept up with yearly inflation and associated cost for travel. Because of this, reservists filling critical billets, shortfalls, and service requirements within the RC are not being adequately compensated for their travel costs. The increased cost of travel due to rising airline and gas prices are detrimental to the overall need of the services to retain forces both for talent management and fulfilling NDAA authorized end strength requirements.

The maximum allowable reimbursement should be increased from \$500 to \$1,500 for each round trip, which can be limited by the Service Secretary. Mileage reimbursement rate should be changed from the current "other mileage rate" as the \$0.22 per mile does not adequately compensate service members driving personally owned vehicles to travel to and from IDT periods and is not in parity with active-duty mileage rates for personal vehicle use.

Issue 2023-07: LOD for Reserve Component Marines in DEERS

Recommendation:

The Board voted to action this issue and collaborate with the NNRPB. In the joint session there was a vested interest regarding not only the MCRPB specific matter, but other Line-of-Duty (LOD) and medical treatment issues for the reserve component of both branches.

Background:

Reserve Component (RC) Marines with Service-approved line-of-duty (LOD) conditions are experiencing barriers in accessing care due to showing as "ineligible" for care within the Defense Enrollment Eligibility Reporting System (DEERS).

The policies and procedures in place to ensure Marine reservists and Officer Candidates that are injured while in a duty status and get approved for LOD medical treatment and benefits is detailed and requires numerous levels of confirmation and accountability across different platforms and departments.

All the administrative work that is done by the Marine, the command, and the medical staff as well as Reserve Medical Entitlements Determination (RMED), Marine Corps Medical Entitlements Data System (MCMEDS), Wounded Warrior Regiment (WWRO), and Defense Health Agency (DHA) becomes moot when the reserve Marine cannot be entered into DEERS as eligible to receive treatment for the injury via Tricare under an LOD status because there is simply no code to be run for that status.

Reserve Marines are unable to utilize the primary option of seeking follow-on treatment at a Military Treatment Facility (MTF) even if they reside within 50 miles of one, because they are unable to book an appointment online due to not populating in DEERS. Note, they will be in DEERS if they already have Tricare Reserve Select (TRS), but that is not intended to be used for LOD treatment. The Marine is forced to go to the MTF and attempt to book the appointment in person with a letter from DHA. They can be entered for that appointment but sometimes fall off again and must repeat the process.

If the Marine is outside of 50 miles from an MTF, they go through a civilian Tricare network provider. The provider will search for the Marine through the HUMANA system for referrals and will be denied because they are not run in DEERS and are not eligible for Tricare due to the lack of the LOD specific code. Civilian providers who don't understand the LOD process will sometimes treat the Marine anyway and then the Marine begins to accrue bills that do not get paid out leading to financial hardship.

According to Mr. Brokaw, a Program Manager at WWR, this exact problem of not having a code for DEERS to run reservists and Officer candidates for LOD eligible Tricare treatment was brought up at a Defense Management Data Center (DMDC) symposium in 2008 and 2011 in Monterey, CA. They were interested in fixing it but said it is DOD wide problem and each branch of service has their own system that would have to be recoded to speak with DEERS to run this new code. Until every service asks for it, they will not create it.

In the meantime, Marines fail to receive medical treatment, deal with financial hardships from care provided and not covered, do not progress in the Marine Corps and sometimes cannot return to civilian employment due to the injury.

Issue 2023-11: BAH Options for ADOS PCS eligible orders

Ref: (a) JTR

Recommendation:

The Board voted to develop proposed language, in coordination with the NNRPE, that would provide adequate BAH entitlements for RC members who accept AD orders over 180 days without causing undue hardship for households/families residing at the member's Primary Residence Address (PRA).

Background:

Per reference (a), RC members on AD orders over 180 days receive PCS orders and BAH at the assigned Permanent Duty Station (PDS) while AD orders under 181 days receive PCS at the members PRA location along with being authorized TDY per diem.

Often RC members accept orders over 180 days and are doing so as a benefit to the service. They are filling critical shortfalls or special duty requirements while also reducing the financial burden of additional TDY per diem costs. Occasionally this comes as a detriment to the service member as they do not execute a full PCS with Household Goods (HHG) shipping authorization to the new PDS for various reasons, and the service member maintains their PRA housing costs despite receiving a lower BAH at the PDS.

Reasons for members not executing a PCS with HHG include having dependents with occupations at the PRA location, having children enrolled in school, or owning their home. It is unreasonable to force a service member to execute PCS orders, move their family, and sell their homes when: (1) the orders are short-term (less than 365 days), (2) the service member will be returning to the original location of the orders being issued, and (3) have legitimate reasons to maintain their PRA BAH.

The Board recommends a change to the JTR to allow RC members in receipt of eligible PCS orders to opt to retain the PRA BAH rate with the understanding that they will return to that location at the completion of the orders. This is similar to "unaccompanied tours" or what the Air Force classifies as "follow-on" orders.

ENCLOSURE 3 - MCRPB Marine Corps Issue Recommendations

Issue 2014-b: Telecommuting for IDTs

Ref: (a) MARADMIN 336-23
(b) MCO 1001R.1L w/Ch1

Recommendation:

The Board voted to close the issue due to the publication of reference (a) on 29 June 2023 allowing Commanding Officers & Operational Sponsors to authorize IDTs in a telecommute status.

Background:

Reference (b) Chapter 7; Sect 3 limits telecommuting to Additional Training periods/Readiness Management Periods (ATP/RMP). The reference excludes IDT as IDTs are "specific to building unit cohesion". The Office of the Secretary of Defense Memorandum Military Personnel Guidance for DoD Components in Responding to CORONAVIRUS Disease 2019 (23 Mar 2020) opened new opportunities including an exception to the in-person attendance portion of DoDI 1215.06. This exception was granted only due to local conditions from COVID-19. On 11 May 2023 the President ended the COVID emergency declaration. As a result, the in-person attendance requirement for IDT was reimposed. The publication of reference (a) authorizes Commanding Officer and Operational Sponsor discretion in conduct of telecommute IDTs where it is appropriate.

Of note, the NNRPB recommends presumption of telework eligibility for Navy Reserve.

Issue 2019-05: Conducting Administrative Separation Boards via VTC

Recommendation:

The Board supports allowing administrative separation boards to be conducted via Video Teleconference (VTC) and recommends that continued progress be made in publishing an updated MARCORSEPMAN. In the interim, the Board recommends exploring through the relevant authorities the potential for release of a MARADMIN to effect an earlier change in this policy.

Background:

Initially submitted to and selected for consideration by the Board in 2019, this issue focuses on the friction and cost imposed by the current MARCORSEPMAN verbiage that the respondent "has the right to appear in person before the board".

DoDI 1332.14 states that the respondent has the "right to request a hearing before an administrative board" and that the "failure to appear without good cause at a hearing constitutes waiver of the right to be present at the hearing." Under the wording of the DoDI regulations, a respondent can appear via VTC, but the MARCORSEPMAN's more restrictive language does not allow for remote appearances.

Marine Forces Reserve currently spends approximately \$400,000 a year on travel expenses associated with Administrative Separation Boards. In addition to travel expenses, there are significant delays in processing Marines due to the in-person attendance requirements of board members given the significant geographical dispersion of MARFORRES personnel.

Issue 2019-06: Parity Between Enlisted and Officer Separations for Drug Abuse

Recommendation:

The Board supports establishing parity between Officer and Enlisted administrative separations for drug abuse and recommends that continued progress be made in publishing an updated MARCORSEPMAN. In the interim the Board recommends exploring through the relevant authorities the potential for release of a MARADMIN to effect an earlier change in this policy.

Background:

Initially submitted to and selected for consideration by the Board in 2019, this issue focuses on the disparity between enlisted and officer separations due to drug abuse.

Enlisted Reservists being processed for administrative separation due to drug abuse are not subjected to the same regulations as Officers. Both the MARCORSEPMAN and SECNAVINST 1920.6D (Administrative Separation of Officers) limit the Department of the Navy's ability to consider a reservist's conduct in the civilian community when determining a characterization of service. Both orders require such conduct to have an overall effectiveness of their naval service. However, only the Officer Separation Order deems that drug abuse by an Officer necessarily affects readiness and performance of military duties. The omission of this provision in the MARCORSEPMAN creates disparity between the two separation processes.

Issue 2022-01: Rental Car Authorization for IMA

Ref: (a) MARADMIN 337-23

Recommendation:

The Board voted to monitor this issue based on the release of reference (a) and a subsequent MARFORRES release of Clarifying Guidance Regarding Rental Vehicles and AT Orders Released by GS-13 Robin Porsche, G1/Ops Asst OpsO, MARFORRES on 16 August 23.

Background:

With the increasing divestment of lodging and messing facilities on bases where Reservists drill as their HTC (Home Training Center), paying for transportation from the government billeted hotel to their workplace is increasingly being shouldered by the Reserve member given the MCRAMM had a specific example paragraph barring rental cars. After discussion at the spring meeting and staffing through M&RA members on the board, a MARADMIN provided an update in advance of final publication of the MCRAMM revision which eliminated the example prohibiting rental cars in all situations, resulting in allowing Commander's discretion to authorize a rental car.

The clarifying guidance from MARFORRES removed this discretion and prohibited rental cars in all situations based on USMC Finance Programming Manual (FPM) guidance. M&RA has asserted that the FPM guidance will be removed to provide commander's discretion. When the FPM guidance is removed, the MCRPB will monitor any communications from MARFORRES as a result of this change. If Commander's discretion remains prohibited at MARFORRES level, the MCRPB will deliberate on whether to re-open the issue.

After the board adjourned, but prior to the completion of this annual report, the FPM was updated and MARFORRES published updated guidance allowing Commander's discretion. Board will likely vote to close issue at its next meeting.

Issue 2022-03: Requirement for Reservists to PCS to CI/HUMINT Basic Course

Ref: (a) MCRPB Annual Report for 2022
(b) USMC Comments on MCRPB Annual Report Recommendations

Recommendation:

This issue was documented in reference (a). The Board voted to accept, monitor, and advocate for the issue with an update to the JTR and/or a legislative proposal to fix the issue. Within reference (b) it was noted that the 2023 National Defense Authorization Act, Section 625 allows the Secretary of the military department to authorize temporary duty status for members attending professional military education or training classes within the United States, for a period of not more than one year, with orders to return to the duty station where the member maintains primary residence and dependents of such members reside, making this an issue within the Marine Corp's purview to change. As such, the board will monitor this issue within the Marine Corps.

Background:

Certain training courses, including counterintelligence & human intelligence (CI/HUMINT) exceed 140 days requiring PCS orders vice TDY. It is unreasonable for Reserve service members with dependents to relocate their family members to this temporary duty station. As a result, most RC members maintain dual households for the roughly six-month course duration at a personal cost of thousands of dollars.

Per reference (b), the Department of the Navy may implement a policy to authorize per diem equal to the amount of BAH at the training location, and the Military Advisory Panel is determining the cost to the Marine Corps to implement this policy.

Issue 2022-10: Off-Site Travel Policy

Ref: (a) MARADMIN 147-23 Changes to Off-Site IDT Policy for the Reserve Component

Recommendation:

The Board voted to close this issue due to the recent publication of reference (a). The MARADMIN permits unit commanders to utilize Additional Training Periods (ATPs) to compensate Marines traveling to Off-Site locations if they are performing at least four hours of work for the Marine Corps, providing compensation for time away from civilian occupation.

Background:

Historically, Marines traveling to Off-Site locations are not compensated during the first day of travel. The loss of pay from taking a day off from their civilian employer to travel has financially impacted many Reserve Marines, particularly the junior enlisted. During the CY 23 Spring Meeting, the Board voted to add language to the MCRAMM to allow Marines to be compensated via ATPs during a travel status if the Marines can validate they are conducting Marine Corps-related tasks during that travel day.

Issue 2022-12: Time spent in IRR for SMCR Medals

Recommendation:

The Board voted to action this issue and develop verbiage to be included in the SECNAV 1650.1 Awards Manual update.

Background:

Marines whose three-year eligibility period is interrupted by time in the IRR reset their eligibility for the SMCR medal. This is appropriate for most circumstances when Marines drop to the IRR. Marines who transfer to the IRR for brief periods, such as is common when conducting an IUT, should be exempt for this reset.

Issue 2022-13: MROWs Orders for Appropriate Duty Points (ADPs)

Ref: (a) MCO 1001R.1L MCRAMM

Recommendation:

The Board supports further research on the legality of drafting or not drafting MROWs orders for appropriate duty points.

Background:

SMCR Marines may conduct a lot of work in between scheduled drills, usually without pay. To incentivize this continued work, the Marine Corps authorizes Marines one non-paid point for each 4-hour block worked towards their total retirement points.

Per reference (a) Chapter 3, Section 2, appropriate duty points (ADPs) may be authorized by the unit commander to Marines under their cognizance. The same chapter in MCRAMM lists activities and tasks that are eligible for ADPs. In order to submit for the ADPs, Marines are required to have actual orders and submit form NAVMC 799 documenting their time.

The issuance of orders for ADPs is not consistent across the Marine Corps Reserve commands. Some units input the ADPs into Drill Management Module without actual orders. Other units draft orders for up to an entire year to cover any Marine in the unit who may submit for ADPs.

The Board agrees that the MCRAMM verbiage requires updating to clarify the orders requirement and make it consistent across the Marine Corps Reserves.

Issue 2022-17: MOS schools longer than 14 days (OTIC & GCEOS)

Recommendation:

The Board voted to close this issue. The issue is primarily related to available funding and school seats, and not a policy limitation. Further, it impacts a small population of the RC.

Background:

A recurring issue has been the mismatch between the length of required training courses and the standard 14-day Annual Training (AT) period. This challenge is particularly prevalent in the 03XX community, which consists of Infantry Marines. The dilemma centers around two core aspects: the allocation of course seats and the availability of funds to support Marines attending extended training programs.

To address this issue, the Board's Annual Report recommended that Training and Education Command (TECOM) consider offering shorter Military Occupational Specialty (MOS) courses that align with the standard 14-day AT period. However, TECOM non-concurred with the recommendation, arguing that the existing course lengths are already the minimum required to meet essential training objectives.

Given TECOM's stance, the Board contemplated requesting a waiver via the MOS manual, an action that falls under the purview of Marine Forces Reserve (MARFORRES) G-3. Additionally, the Board has discussed elevating this issue to the National Naval Reserve Policy Board (NNRPB) for collaborative discussion and potential resolution.

This background sets the stage for ongoing deliberations about how to reconcile the operational needs of the Marine Corps with the logistical and financial constraints faced by Marines, particularly those in specialized roles requiring extended training.

Issue 2023-01: Restricted Officer Assignments

Recommendation:

The Board rejected this issue as it applies to an extremely limited population and change to the policy could result in future issues filling critical billets designated for restricted officers who are the subject matter experts within their field.

Background:

NAVMC 1200.1 states that "Restricted Officers cannot hold non-primary MOSs and will be limited to PMOS-BMOS matches". The submitter of this issue identified how this policy is myopic in nature and disincentivizes restricted officers from attending courses and gaining additional skills/MOS designations that can benefit them and their units.

A deep discussion regarding this topic occurred between board members to determine if removal of the restriction or adding a method for obtaining an exemption to the policy would benefit the Marine Corps. Although it could be added benefit, it could also lead to a degradation of filling those critical billets only available to restricted officers. This is especially concerning with today's current problem with manpower shortfalls and not having enough restricted officers to fill the current requirements. Further, if these restricted officers occupied critical billets outside of their primary MOS, it would have second order effects on junior restricted officers, preventing or delaying their opportunity for promotion and advancement.

Issue 2023-06: TS/SCI Obligation Requirements for MOS 1721

Ref: (a) MARADMIN 102/22: Establishment of The Information Maneuver 1700 Occupational Field
(b) DoDI 5200.02 DoD Personnel Security Program

Recommendation:

The Board voted to support and advocate for research on use of bonuses and obligated time to address this issue.

Background:

The Cyberspace Warfare Operator Military MOS (1721) was established by reference (a). The MOS is a low density, high demand occupational field requiring a fully adjudicated Top Secret Secure Compartmented Information (TS/SCI) clearance for new candidates entering the 255-day Joint Cyber Analysis Course. No interim clearances are authorized due to the highly sensitive nature of the training.

Currently, the background investigation process is backlogged in which TS adjudications are finalized up to 18-24 months after initiation. In some cases, fully qualified Marine candidates for this field choose to drop to the Individual Ready Reserve once receiving their TS clearance and fail to continue onto training. These Marines are non-obligated to continue drilling until they complete the training and receive an Enlisted Affiliation Bonus (EAB). This creates a significant manning shortfall for the high demand MOS.

The Board supports efforts to establish a Separate Written Agreement to Train (SWAT) and/or a Statement of Understanding (SOU) in which the candidate Marine is obligated to serve a specified period upon receiving their fully adjudicated TS clearance.

The Board supports efforts to split the EAB awarded for these Marines at 25% upon successful screening and lateral move and the remaining 75% upon successful graduation of the MOS-producing courses.

Furthermore, the Board recommends advocacy from HQMC to propose prioritized investigations for the 1721 MOS with the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency to incentivize recruiting and retention by accelerating entry to MOS training. This recommendation does not account for potential increase costs of prioritized requests for clearance adjudication.

Separate from the administrative efficiencies and service member retention ultimately to be gained, the Board supports this effort, in principle, and expressed in reference (b) a desire to continue to monitor potential implementation at the HQMC level.

Issue 2023-15: Composition of Reserve Component Promotion and Selection Boards

Recommendation:

The Board voted to close this issue based on a discussion with M&RA representatives that are aware of the past directive of the previous Commandant in 2020 to maximize Active-Duty members on Reserve Boards and will start actively modifying the composition of the boards to the pre-2020 level.

Background:

Since the Commandant's 2020 directive to maximize Active officer membership on Reserve Officer Statutory and non-Statutory boards within Title 10 and the SECNAVINST 1401.3B, boards have consistently increased Active-Duty Board membership to no less than 50%. Additionally, when Active Reserve members (counted as Reserve Members since they are part of the Reserve Active Status List and not the Active-Duty List) are included, there is approximately 30-40% Reserve officer membership on Reserve Officer boards.

As an information paper generated by MMPR provided to the Commandant in 2020 asserts, "Maintaining a majority reserve component representation on non-statutory boards ensures for a reserve component identity and ownership of the board's results that directly impacts their component readiness." It continues, "Increasing active component representation to no less than 50% for reserve boards may be detrimental to the efficiency and proficiency of reserve boards and compromise results due to the differences and lack of understanding of reserve performance records (Career Retirement Credit Report, Reserve Qualification Summary, "sat" year, broken time, lack of observation relative to active component counterpart, SMCR/IRR/IMA, etc.) that active board members heavily rely upon their reserve counterparts to educate them on; what level of participation should I be looking for? What constitutes competitiveness? What's preferred, MARFORES HQs time or operational time? What's preferred, joining an SMCR unit or successive IA tours? etc."

Despite these recommendations, the Commandant executed his desired 50% minimum Active Duty on reserve boards. This issue was created to highlight this significant policy change and create momentum to both reverse the policy to pre-2020 standard operating procedures and possibly increase Reserve participation to even higher levels to assist with optimal talent management.

ENCLOSURE 4 - MCRPB Nominated Membership for 2024-2026

KEPT SEPARATE FOR CONFIDENTIALITY